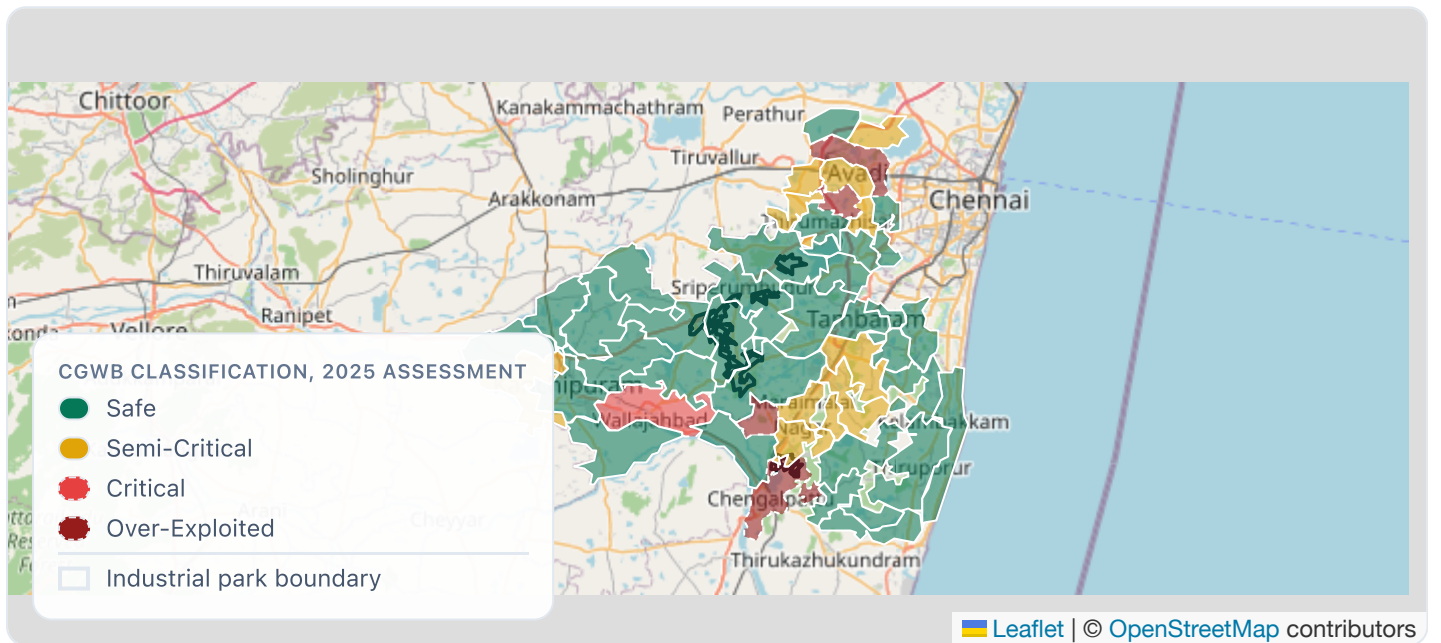


Sriperumbudur-Oragadam Industrial Corridor

What is the aquifer under Chennai's manufacturing belt actually doing? In the regulator's 2025 assessment, the answer is **Safe, with four asterisks**.

1. **The taluks hosting the parks are classified Safe.** Every SIPCOT estate sits in Sriperumbudur taluk (24.5% stage of extraction, 2025 edition) or spills into Kundrathur (27.9%); 8 of the corridor's 10 taluks are Safe. The two Semi-Critical taluks: Avadi (83.2%) on the northern rim, and Chengalpattu (78.8%), which hosts Mahindra World City. The 2017 edition counted 22 over-exploited firkas across these (then-undivided) districts; the 2025 edition counts 5.
2. **Taluk averages hide stressed units.** Of 47 corridor firkas, 4 are Over-Exploited and 1 Critical in the 2025 edition, all inside taluks whose headline class is Safe or Semi-Critical. The map below shows the firka picture that official taluk tables average away.
3. **Extraction permission here is legally dense and publicly untraceable.** Tamil Nadu regulates groundwater through a state executive-order scheme, not CGWA, and no authority in the chain publishes a register of permissions granted.
4. **The parks' documented lifeline is surface water.** SIPCOT's own clearance filings put the estates on CMWSSB supply from Chembarambakkam Lake plus treated reuse (TTRO) water, with groundwater "drawl" prohibited under at least one park's EC. The corridor's water risk runs through a reservoir it shares with the city; in the 2019 crisis Chembarambakkam fell effectively to zero.



CGWB assessment-unit (firka) polygons, 2025 classification, with SIPCOT park outer boundaries. Geometry: IN-GRES GeoServer (CGWB) and SIPCOT GIS; nothing drawn or interpolated by us. Base map © OpenStreetMap contributors.

Every taluk, three editions (2023, 2024, 2025)

TALUK	DISTRICT	2023 STAGE %	2024 STAGE %	2025 STAGE %	TREND	CLASSIFICATION
Avadi	Tiruvallur	83.9	83.7	83.2	→	● Semi-Critical
Chengalpattu	Chengalpattu	85	83.6	78.8	▼	● Semi-Critical
Poonamallee	Tiruvallur	67.7	66.6	67.9	→	● Safe
Vandalur	Chengalpattu	64.3	60.2	55.4	▼	● Safe
Walajabad	Kancheepuram	60.1	58.4	55.2	▼	● Safe
Thirupporur	Chengalpattu	59	58.5	52.1	▼	● Safe
Kancheepuram	Kancheepuram	47.7	48.8	51	▲	● Safe
Tambaram	Chengalpattu	35.7	33.3	36.8	→	● Safe
Kundrathur	Kancheepuram	31.4	32	27.9	⇌	● Safe
Sriperumbudur	Kancheepuram	21	21.3	24.5	▲	● Safe

Trend rule: flat within 2 percentage points net across the three editions; rising/falling only when both inter-edition steps agree with the net direction; mixed otherwise. Verification: 10/10 taluk and 47/47 firka rows cross-checked against the CGWB/TN WRD state report annexure and the national categorization list, 0 mismatches.

Who issues extraction permission here

TN repealed its groundwater act in 2013 (Act 23 of 2013) and enacted no replacement. Industrial extraction NOCs come from the State Ground and Surface Water Resources Data Centre (WRD) under G.O. Ms. 51/2004 and G.O. Ms. 142/2014 (upheld, Madras HC, Oct 2018), via e-District service WRD-101; TNPCB and BIS grant consents only after the state NOC (CAG Report 9 of 2021, ch. 3).

The Chennai Metropolitan Area Groundwater (Regulation) Act 1987 reaches only the villages in its own Schedule. The 2022 CMA expansion (G.O. Ms. 184, 21.10.2022) moved the planning boundary over Sriperumbudur taluk, but no Schedule notification under s.17-A has been found, so the Act does not, on the record we could locate, cover these parks.

CGWA's framework, and its status here

CGWA's 2020 guidelines (S.O. 3289(E)) tier obligations by these same categories: no new non-MSME NOCs in Over-Exploited units; annual water audits above 100 m3/day with 20% reduction over three years; recharge mandates; tiered charges; telemetry.

In Tamil Nadu CGWA issues no NOCs: its own state list names TN self-regulating, the Rajya Sabha UQ 2971 annexure of all NOCs 2017-2023 has no TN row, no TN area is CGWA-notified, and the SG&SWRDC stated in July 2022 that CGWA's extraction notice "does not apply for TN". The guidelines claim pan-India applicability on paper; that tension is documented and unresolved.

Named gap: no known public register of groundwater extraction permissions covers this corridor, from any of the three authorities. The nearest public instrument, TNPCB's consent database, records permitted effluent discharge, not water intake.

Sources. Dynamic Ground Water Resource Assessment (CGWB and TN SG&SWRDC), editions 2023-2025, served by IN-GRES (ingres.iith.ac.in), cross-checked against the 2025 state report firka annexure and the national block-wise categorization list; SIPCOT GIS park boundaries (attribution, reuse confirmation requested); SIPCOT EC compliance filings (per-park water sources, e.g. Pillaipakkam EC ID EC22B039TN146946); CMWSSB daily reservoir readings; statutes and notifications as cited on the live page. Every number carries its edition and retrieval date (2026-07-27).

What we do not claim. Park locations are public-record facts. This brief does not state or imply that any company or park depletes the aquifer or causes any unit's classification; our data cannot support that attribution.

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